

Activity Guide — senior / module-08-yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Testing Patañjali’s Dual Criterion

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Day:** 3 · **Time:** 15 min within Day 3

Goal

Students hold three postures and self-assess against YS 2.46 (*sthira-sukham āsanam*).

Materials

- Yoga mats
- Stopwatch
- Reflection worksheet (below)

Instructions

Hold each pose. After each, immediately rate: - **Sthira** (steady): 1–5 - **Sukha** (comfortable): 1–5 - Both?

Sequence

Pose	Hold	Notes
Tāḍāsana	60 sec	Standing, easiest to score
Vṛkṣāsana (right)	30 sec	Balance challenge
Balāsana	90 sec	Rest — should be easy on both

Reflection worksheet

Pose	Sthira (1–5)	Sukha (1–5)	Both? Y/N	Notes
Tāḍāsana				
Vṛkṣāsana				
Balāsana				

Discussion (5 min after)

- Which pose best met BOTH criteria for you, today?
- Which one was steady but not comfortable? Comfortable but not steady?
- What might *prayatna-saithilya* (relaxation of effort) look like for the pose where you struggled most?

Safety

- Standard rules: opt-out anytime, vṛkṣāsana foot above/below knee not on it.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try adho-mukha-śvānāsana (downward dog) — does it meet the criterion?
- **Tier down:** Skip vṛkṣāsana; do tādāsana + balāsana only.

Clean-up

- Worksheets collected — feeds into Day 3’s reflection writing.

Project Brief

Project — Module 8 Yoga (Senior)

Type: 5–6 page research-synthesis paper · **Marks:** 65

Topic options

Choose one or propose:

1. **Does the counted-breath prāṇāyāma practice we learned have measurable effects on heart-rate variability?** Review 2–3 contemporary studies and reach a conclusion.
2. **Patañjali defines āsana as “steady and comfortable” (YS 2.46). Does modern postural yoga meet this criterion?** Use 3 specific postures as evidence.
3. **Evaluate Singleton’s (2010) historical thesis** on modern postural yoga. Argue for, against, or qualified position.
4. **Compare Patañjali’s prāṇāyāma framework (YS 2.49–53) with the polyvagal theory’s account** of breath effects. What does each frame capture?
5. **Trace one specific āsana** from its earliest textual mention (if any) to its modern form. What does the history reveal?

Required elements

Your paper MUST cite:

- **One** classical primary source (YS, BG, or SB verse in IAST + translation).

- **One** historical scholarly source (Singleton, De Michelis, Sjoman, or equivalent).
- **One** peer-reviewed modern research paper (Porges, Streeter, Pascoe, or your own discovery).

Plus: - Clear thesis in opening paragraph. - One steel-manned counter-argument with response. - Works-cited page (MLA or Chicago).

Format

- 5–6 pages, double-spaced, 12pt.
- Title page with name, class, thesis.

Schedule

- Day 7: choose topic.
- Day 8: outline submitted.
- Day 9: draft (≥ 2 pages).
- Day 10: paper submitted.

Rubric

See `rubric.md`.

Self-reflection (1 paragraph)

1. Topic + why.
2. Most challenging part.
3. With 3 more days, what to research deeper.